Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Friday, 30 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Mostly clear	Overcast	Overcast	Overcast
16° 11°	15° 8°	15° 10°	15° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Prime Minister says he wants to cut the welfare bill 'as soon as we possibly can', but hasn't given a timetable for any reductions.**
Opponents have questioned the Budget's lack of detail on welfare reform. The Chancellor says the government has a 'moral duty' to help young people out of work.
POLITICS · UK

2 **Russell Brand's wife, Laura, has told his rape trial that he is 'kind and a wonderful father'.**
She told the jury that she feels 'very seen by him' and 'I love him very much'. The trial is ongoing.
CRIME · UK

3 **The DUP has blocked Michelle O'Neill's engagements over the Drumcree parade issue.**
DUP leader Gavin Robinson has confirmed that Emma Little-Pengelly will not participate in joint engagements with O'Neill. The political dispute continues.
POLITICS · UK

4 **There's a warning that the boom in weight-loss jabs is putting recycling centre workers at risk.**
Recycling bosses say used needles are increasingly being found among household waste. This poses a significant hazard to staff.
HEALTH · UK

5 **Ofcom has outlined various age check methods ahead of a potential social media ban for under-16s.**
They suggest photo and digital ID, banking checks, or facial age estimation could help prove someone is 16 or over. This is part of new online safety measures.
TECHNOLOGY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **An AI micro-drama edit of Neighbours is causing some worry among actors and crew.**

The project will use AI-assisted technology to edit old episodes of the Australian TV soap. It aims to focus specifically on Margot Robbie's character.

> ON AIR — What do we make of AI editing classic TV shows? Is it a clever new way to enjoy old favourites, or does it take away from the original magic?

TV · FUTURE

2 **An actor is campaigning against the 'scarred villain' stereotype often seen on screen.**

Robert Rhodes says people with scars 'experience joy, love and success just like everyone else'. He wants to see more varied representations in film and TV.

> ON AIR — Do you think certain physical characteristics are unfairly linked to negative roles in movies? Is it time for a change in how characters are portrayed?

FILM · FUTURE

3 **Liverpool's long-delayed Littlewoods film studios plan has been given a £20m boost in the Budget.**

The redevelopment is subject to final approval, with calls for strict oversight. This could be a big step for the city's creative industry.

> ON AIR — Great news for Liverpool! Do you think more investment in regional film studios is what the UK needs to boost its creative sector?

FILM · FUTURE

4 **The Babydoll singer says life will 'never be the same again' after achieving a UK number one.**

The artist is finding genuine joy in life again after a difficult period led to them quitting music. It's a fantastic comeback story for them.

> ON AIR — It's always lovely to hear about artists finding joy and success after a tough time. What's your favourite comeback story in music?

MUSIC · NOW

5 **YouTuber Jacksepticeye, Seán McLoughlin, is branching out, saying 'the internet's a less whimsical place'.**

He became famous playing video games, but now you're more likely to see him in other projects. He's exploring new avenues beyond his gaming roots.

> ON AIR — Many YouTubers are diversifying their content. What kind of new ventures would you like to see your favourite online personalities try?

ONLINE · FUTURE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Jack Grealish has been dropped by Everton after a 'breach of club discipline'.**

He was left out of Everton's Carabao Cup tie with Newcastle United on Thursday. It's a significant move by the club.

ON AIR — Club discipline in football – how important is it, and should players always be held accountable publicly for breaches?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Kimi Antonelli is set to miss Thursday's Mexico City Grand Prix media day due to illness.**

He is on the brink of clinching his first world title. This could be a nervous wait for the young driver.

ON AIR — With Antonelli on the verge of a world title, how much does missing a media day really affect a driver's focus or preparation?

F1 · UK

3 **The Milwaukee Brewers have won their first World Series in the franchise's 57-year history.**

They beat the Tampa Bay Rays in game five on Wednesday. It's a historic victory for the team and their fans.

ON AIR — A 57-year wait for a World Series title! What's the longest you've waited for your team to win a major trophy, and how did it feel when they finally did?

BASEBALL · WORLD

4 **Three-time Grand Slam champion Stan Wawrinka has retired in front of his home crowd.**

He lost in straight sets to Jiri Lehecka in the opening round of the Swiss Indoors in Basel. It marks the end of an incredible career.

ON AIR — Stan Wawrinka retiring is a big moment in tennis. Who are some of the other sporting legends you've seen retire, and what made their farewell memorable?

TENNIS · WORLD

5 **Harry Kane has been crowned the men's 2026 Ballon d'Or winner, the first English player since Michael Owen in 2001.**

You can watch his best goals from the 2025/26 Bundesliga season with Bayern. It's a huge achievement for the England striker.

ON AIR — Harry Kane winning the Ballon d'Or is massive! Do you think this solidifies his place as one of England's greatest ever strikers?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Britons are keeping their phones for longer than ever before upgrading.**
The average handset is now held onto for several years. The main reason cited isn't loyalty — it's the dread of moving everything across.

2 **More people are writing 'done lists' instead of to-do lists to feel better about their day.**
Noting what you actually achieved, however small, apparently beats staring at everything you didn't. 'Got dressed' counts.

3 **Cycling to the shops is up, with more people using bikes for short local trips rather than big rides.**
Councils credit better cycle lanes. The number one cargo carried? A surprisingly heavy single bag for life.

4 **A study says the smell of fresh bread is one of the few things almost everyone finds comforting.**
Supermarkets have long known it — the in-store bakery is no accident. Few of us escape without an unplanned loaf.

5 **Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.

6 **Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.

7 **Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.

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05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **61% of us have lied about THIS to get out of a social event. What?**

ANSWER: HAVING A COLD.

Q **53% of people admit to doing THIS in a restaurant when no-one's looking. What?**

ANSWER: LICKING THE PLATE.

TALK TOPIC

- **Scientists say humans can recognise a friend just from the sound of them walking.**
  Who can you identify by their footsteps alone — and has anyone ever crept up and caught you out?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Bananas are slightly radioactive because they contain potassium — though you'd need to eat an impossible number in one go for it to matter at all.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A garden centre in Kent has had to rename its 'quiet corner' after customers kept falling asleep in the deckchairs and missing closing time.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The total weight of all the ants on Earth is comparable to the total weight of all the humans.
- Bees can fly higher than Mount Everest, at least in lab tests.
- Scotland's national animal, the unicorn, was chosen partly because it was seen as a natural enemy of the English lion.
- Your stomach gets a brand-new lining every few days so it doesn't digest itself.
- The Spanish national anthem has no words.
- A shrimp's heart is in its head.
- Lobsters taste with their legs and chew with their stomachs.
- The 'new car smell' is the scent of dozens of chemicals slowly evaporating.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES FRI 30 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 303 of the year, 62 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Declaration of the Slovak Nation (Slovakia); Christian feast day: Ethelnoth (Egelnoth) the Good; Christian feast day: Blessed Benvenuta Bojani; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins (Catholic, Ireland, Society of Jesus). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1945 — Lynne Marta, American actress (died 2024)
- 1954 — T. Graham Brown, American country singer-songwriter
- 1956 — Juliet Stevenson, English actress
- 1947 — Herschel Weingrod, American screenwriter and producer
- 1947 — Timothy B. Schmit, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1996 — Kennedy McMann, American actress
- 1960 — Grayson Hugh, American singer-songwriter
- 1973 — Michael Oakes, English footballer and manager

THE DAY TODAY

- 2015 — A fire in a nightclub in the Romanian capital of Bucharest kills sixty-four people and leaves more than 147 injured.
- 2005 — The rebuilt Dresden Frauenkirche (destroyed in the firebombing of Dresden during World War II) is reconsecrated after a thirteen-year rebuilding project.
- 1947 — The General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT), the foundation of the World Trade Organization (WTO), is founded.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1991 — The Israeli-Palestinian conflict: The Madrid Conference commences in an effort to revive peace negotiations between Israel and Palestine.
- 2023 — First rescue of a prisoner during the Israeli invasion of Gaza.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1944 — Holocaust: Anne and Margot Frank are deported from Auschwitz to the Bergen-Belsen concentration camp, where they die from disease the following year, shortly before the end of WWII.
- 1961 — The Soviet Union detonates the Tsar Bomba, the most powerful explosive device ever detonated.

- 1980 — El Salvador and Honduras agree to put the border dispute fought over in 1969's Football War before the International Court of Justice.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SAT 31 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 304 of the year, 61 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alphonsus Rodriguez; Christian feast day: Ampliatus; Christian feast day: Begu; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Johnny Whitworth, American actor and producer
- 1976 — Piper Perabo, American actress and producer
- 1945 — Russ Ballard, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1939 — Ron Rifkin, American actor
- 1941 — Sally Kirkland, American actress (died 2025)
- 1997 — Marcus Rashford, English footballer
- 1973 — Paul Abrahams, English footballer and coach
- 1997 — Sydney Park, American actress and comedian

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2003 — Mahathir Mohamad resigns as Prime Minister of Malaysia and is replaced by Deputy Prime Minister Abdullah Ahmad Badawi, marking an end to Mahathir's 22 years in power.
- 1943 — World War II: An F4U Corsair accomplishes the first successful radar-guided interception by a United States Navy or Marine Corps aircraft.
- 1984 — Indian Prime Minister Indira Gandhi is assassinated by two Sikh security guards. Riots break out in New Delhi and other cities and around 3,000 Sikhs are killed.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1996 — TAM Transportes Aéreos Regionais Flight 402 crashes in São Paulo, Brazil, killing 99 people.
- 1994 — American Eagle Flight 4184 crashes near Roselawn, Indiana killing all 68 people on board.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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